



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	6 May 2024	Time of Incident	5.30pm
Directorate / Region	RMO – Kimberley	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type	SHW Procedure Breach	EQSafe Incident Number	40218
Actual Consequence	Minor	Potential Consequence	Major

Incident Short Description	Contractor failed to arrive to site, prompting search and rescue
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Executive Summary

On afternoon of 6th May, the Contractor (IP) arrived in Kununurra on a flight from Darwin. The IP was to drive out to the Tanami project site with other workers as a convoy and was expected to arrive on site around 5pm. The estimated journey time to Tanami was a minimum of 4.5 hours.

The IP chose to drive their own personal vehicle as they did not want to leave it at the airport. The IP was witnessed leaving Kununurra just after 4pm and considering the journey time, they would arrive after dusk. They failed to notify their supervisor of this decision and the change of journey plan.

At approximately 5.30pm at the Tanami site, supervisors were notified that the IP had not arrived on site at the expected arrival time. The supervisor immediately notified the Project Manager and prompted the search and rescue procedure, including notifying the IP's company and local police to assist in locating the missing contractor.

The Main Roads supervisor drove in the direction of the expected travel of the IP, and the police search commenced.

There were multiple attempts to contact the IP by the Main Roads management team, the IP's management team and local police. Contact was made but due to poor reception, insufficient information was gathered. It was established that members of public had stopped to help the IP.

At 8:40pm, the local police located the IP asleep in their vehicle, which was off the road.

The IP stated that a kangaroo had jumped onto the road, and they swerved to avoid it, overcorrected and the vehicle left the road. The vehicle was found to have two blown front tyres and was not driveable.

Incident Photos

Image taken by the Supervisor on arrival to collect the worker and transport them back to Kununurra

Contributing Factors

- Contract Supervisor did not make appropriate plans for the crew to arrive at site before dark or alternative arrangements i.e. Accommodation in town/earlier flight, to ensure crew were not driving around/after dark.
- Journey Management Planning (JMP) (as covered in the regional safety induction) was not followed, resulting in procedure breach.
- Contractor did not notify their supervisor of their intentions to drive their own vehicle or remain in convoy with the other vehicles.
- Contractor did not notify Supervisor of their estimated later arrival time to camp.
- Contractor did not fully recognise the hazard of not travelling with the convoy of other workers.
- Contractor was driving at dusk, resulting in increased likelihood of encountering fauna/wildlife on the road with reduced visibility.

Corrective Actions

- Project Manager (PM) discussed the importance of adherence to the JMP with the contract company the next day and stated alternative arrangements would need to be put in place if crews could not arrive by dusk.
- Workers reminded to communicate all changes to any travel plans with their supervisor.
- Project Management team and Supervisors to regularly remind all crews at Refocus, Toolboxes and Prestarts of the necessity to follow all Main Roads Procedures.

Additional Issues / Learnings

- Positive communications between work teams are crucial to ensure a clear understanding of procedures and work instructions.
- Procedures are to be followed unless consultation and approval is given by Project Management or Supervisors.

**Critical Risk:**

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to
Vehicles and Driving

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations